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The following is a faithful transcription of typed notes by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

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RELIGION AND ATHEISM DEFINED.

In view of the foregoing "Very earnest words", and the general conditions of society -- including the threatening spread of atheism these days; of which a Jewish rabbi not long / lamented to the writer, especially among the Jewish youth, -- and we might say, most especially because of the lameness of Webster's information on the above; -- surely no one will object to an honest effort at improving on his definitions of subjects so positively vital for and against the individual and general welfare of humanity as are the religion and its would-be destruction, atheism.

First however, it will surely be not too much for us to presume as selfunderstood that any branch of study or learning deserves the distinction of science only inasmuch as it tends to the glory of God and the welfare of His creatures, e. g. the science of music, the science of mathematics, of astronomy, of oratory, etc.

Hence the positive and supremely outstanding claims of religion to such a distinction; for in all branches of knowledge and themes of study and research, where can anything be found whose claims to promoting happiness can even compare in depth of meaning, in broadness of scope, in sublimity and universality and necessity of religion? -- the Great Jehovah Himself, midst the thunders of Sinai proclaiming: "I am the Lord thy God. Thou shalt have no strange gods" just an echo down across the ages from the first instruction and commission to Adam and Eve, confident that in as much as His new creatures were rational so they would be also appreciatively grateful. An echo? Yea, and as history repeats itself among the hills of generations and the mountains of world struggles, so too do the commandments to love God and neighbor -- Jesus Christ Himself, Son of the Living God and true Messiah of the ancient prophecies Himself stressing the same and proclaiming as he does through Christian philosophy, the principle till the end of time and into eternity: "Gratitude for favors received the first and surest indication of intelligence." And thru the present Roman Pontiff, Pope Pius XII: "Man's first and greatest duty and obligation."

Furthermore, not only is Religion a science pertaining to rational creatures on earth, viz, to mankind; but it is the greatest